

023. Chapter 2 Verses 59-63

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.59

विषया विनिवर्तन्ते निराहारस्य देहिनः ।
रसवर्जं रसोऽप्यस्य परं दृष्ट्वा निवर्तते ॥ 59 ॥

viṣayā vinivartante
nirāhārasya dehinaḥ |
rasavarjaṁ raso'pyasya
paraṁ dr̥ṣṭvā nivartate ||

viṣayāḥ – objects of the senses; **vinivartante** – turn away;
nirāhārasya – for the abstinent; **dehinaḥ** – for the embodied;
rasa-varjam – except the relish (taste); **rasaḥ** – relish; **api** – even; **asya** – his;
param – the Supreme; **dr̥ṣṭvā** – having seen; **nivartate** – turns away.

When a man rejects the sense objects by withdrawing the senses, he becomes free from the sense world only. The longing or taste for them still remains in the mind. Even this longing is removed when the self is perceived.

VERSE 2.60

यततो ह्यपि कौन्तेय पुरुषस्य विपश्चितः ।
इन्द्रियाणि प्रमाथीनि हरन्ति प्रसभं मनः ॥ 60 ॥

yatato hyapi kaunteya
puruṣasya vipaścitaḥ |
indriyāṇi pramāthīni
haranti prasabhaṁ manaḥ ||

yatataḥ – striving; **hi** – indeed; **api** – even; **kaunteya** – O son of Kunti;
puruṣasya – of a man; **vipaścitaḥ** – wise;
indriyāṇi – the senses; **pramāthīni** – turbulent;
haranti – carry away; **prasabham** – by force; **manaḥ** – the mind.

O Arjuna! The turbulent senses carry away the mind even of the learned man though he is striving to control them.

VERSE 2.61

तानि सर्वाणि संयम्य युक्त आसीत मत्परः ।
वशे हि यस्येन्द्रियाणि तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 61 ॥

tāni sarvāṇi saṁyamya
yukta āsīta matparaḥ |
vaśe hi yasyendriyāṇi
tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā ||

tāni – them; **sarvān** – all; **saṁyamya** – having controlled;
yuktaḥ – steadfast; **āsīta** – should sit; **matparaḥ** – intent on Me;
vaśe – under control; **hi** – indeed; **yasya** – whose; **indriyāṇi** – senses;
tasya – his; **prajñā** – wisdom; **pratiṣṭhitā** – is established.

Having restrained all the senses the harmonized should sit intent on me. His wisdom is steady whose senses are under control.

ध्यायतो विषयान्पुंसः सङ्गस्तेषूपजायते ।
सङ्गात्सञ्जायते कामः कामात्क्रोधोऽभिजायते ॥ 62 ॥
क्रोधाद्भवति सम्मोहः सम्मोहात्स्मृतिविभ्रमः ।
स्मृतिभ्रंशाद् बुद्धिनाशो बुद्धिनाशात्प्रणश्यति ॥ 63 ॥

dhyāyato viṣayānpuṃsaḥ
saṅgasteṣūpajāyate |
saṅgātsañjāyate kāmah
kāmātkrodho'bhijāyate ||

As a man contemplates sense-objects, attachment for them arises, from attachment, desire for them will be born, from desire arises anger, from anger comes delusion, from delusion, comes loss of memory, from loss of memory, comes destruction of discrimination, and from destruction of discrimination he perishes.